manpower at each level. This plan showed how there would be no change whatsoever in the deployment profile at Battalion or lower levels in the first and second tiers of defence. The changes would only manifest in the third tier and location and application of reserves, that too in a more effective manner. The new formulation was tested in the 33 Corps War Game held that year, and found to be superior. It found much favour at the Battalion and Brigade level; the only ones opposed to it were the Divisional Commanders, who felt they were becoming redundant.

I was convinced that this was a proposal worth taking forward. When I had first discussed it informally with Gen Bipin Rawat, he too seemed favourably inclined. Unknown to me, he was also working on a similar proposal for which the Perspective Planning Directorate (now Strategic Planning Directorate) had been tasked, the only difference being that it was being called the Integrated Battle Group (IBG), instead of Light Division. It was envisaged that each Corps, on conversion, would have five to six 'Light Divisions' instead of the traditional three Divisions to a Corps. This would imply a more than doubling of the number of Divisions, which may look alarmist. Therefore, Gen Bipin Rawat thought that a benign name in the form of IBG would be more suitable, and gave the go-ahead for taking it forward.

When I took over as Chief, I carried forward this proposal, which had the blessings of Gen Rawat, who had now become the CDS. However, Gen Rawat had opined that rather than starting with 33 Corps, which was operationally deployed, we should start with 9 Corps (defensive corps) and 17 Corps (offensive corps) as test-beds. This was also fine with me, and I tasked the PP Directorate to prepare a restructuring plan based on the framework already prepared by 33 Corps. If I

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